

2.1 Unit description

Concept approach	This unit covers waves, electricity and the nature of light. The unit may be taught using either a concept approach or a context approach. The concept approach begins with a study of the laws, theories and models of physics and then explores their practical applications. This section of the specification is presented in a format for teachers who wish to use the concept approach.
Context approach	This unit is presented in a different format on page 53 for teachers who wish to use a context approach. The context approach begins with the consideration of an application that draws on many different areas of physics, and then the laws, theories and models of physics that apply to this application are studied. The context approach for this unit uses three contexts for teaching: music, technology in space and archaeology.
How Science Works	<i>How Science Works – Appendix 3</i> should be integrated with the teaching and learning of this unit. It is expected that students will be given opportunities to use spreadsheets and computer models to analyse and present data, and to make predictions while studying this unit. The word ‘investigate’ indicates where students should develop their practical skills for <i>How Science Works</i>, numbers 1–6 as detailed in <i>Appendix 3</i>. Students should communicate the outcomes of their investigations using appropriate scientific, technical and mathematical language, conventions and symbols. Applications of physics should be studied using a range of contemporary contexts that relate to this unit.